Expressing cause and result (because, so, therefore)

Goal: To link a cause and its result with because, so, therefore, as, since, as a result and that is why, using the correct position and punctuation of each connector.

The idea in two lines: Some connectors introduce the cause (because, as, since), others introduce the result (so, therefore, as a result). The sentence can start with either part, but the connector must match the part it introduces.

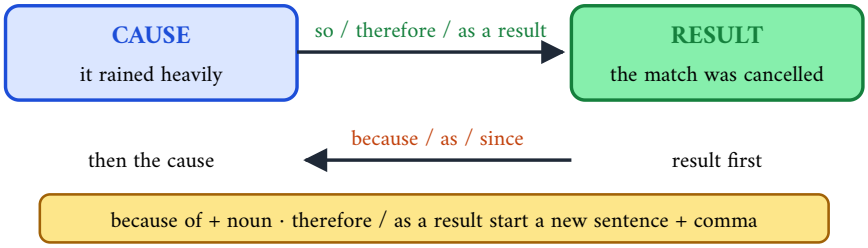


Figure 1: Cause connectors point to the reason; result connectors point to the consequence.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Because / as / since** + clause (subject + verb) introduce the **cause**: The plants died because they had no water. As / since it was late, we went home.
2. **Because of / due to / thanks to** + noun phrase: The match was cancelled because of the rain.
3. **So** + clause introduces the **result** inside the same sentence, after a comma: It was cold, so we stayed in.
4. **Therefore / as a result / consequently / that is why** usually start a new sentence and are followed by a comma: The sample was contaminated. Therefore, the test was repeated.
5. **Order is flexible:** cause first (Because A, B) or result first (B because A). A comma is needed when the because-clause comes first.
6. **Never use "because" and "so" together** to link the same two ideas.

🟢 Examples

1. Join with "so": The water reached 100°C. It turned into steam. **Answer:** The water reached 100°C, so it turned into steam. **Explanation:** the first clause is the cause; "so" introduces the result after a comma.
2. Rewrite with "because": The road was icy; therefore, the car skidded. **Answer:** The car skidded because the road was icy. **Explanation:** the result comes first, then "because" introduces the cause.
3. Complete with "because of" or "because": The flight was delayed ... the fog. / We stayed inside ... it was raining. **Answer:** because of the fog / because it was raining. **Explanation:** "because of" + noun, "because" + clause.

🟠 Common BAC mistakes

- Writing "because" + noun alone: "because the rain" instead of "because of the rain".
- Using "so" to introduce a cause: "I stayed home so I was ill."
- Doubling the connectors: "Because it rained, so we stayed in."
- Forgetting the comma after "therefore" or "as a result" at the start of a sentence.

🟡 Quick review

- Cause: because / as / since + clause; because of + noun.
- Result: so (same sentence), therefore / as a result (new sentence + comma).
- Result + because + cause, or Because + cause, + result.
- One connector per link: never "because ... so".
- Ask "why?" → cause; ask "what happened then?" → result.

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